



Anti-Confederate satire

The Union blasts away at the monster of secession in a cartoon of 1861. Demons represent secessionist states—divided Kentucky is depicted as a creature with two torsos just above the monster's head.

Strategic state

With its people so finely divided, Kentucky tried to remain neutral after the attack on Fort Sumter. But this was an inherently untenable position, and by September 1861 it had collapsed. The governor, Beriah Magoffin, sympathized with the Confederacy but was only willing to go as far as a secret agreement that permitted its recruiters to enter the territory.

Unionist and pro-Confederate Kentuckians began to arm themselves during the state's tense period of neutrality. Lincoln, who knew this region well, bided his time, initially humoring his home state's desire to stay out of the war, and even allowing the Confederacy to purchase supplies there. In Congressional and legislative elections that summer, Unionists scored crushing